

Reflection 1

- Minimum 2 - pages (does not include cover page, abstract, or reference page. The reference page is the only one that is required)
- **Use of relevant course materials with citations** (textbook, research articles, videos, links, etc.)
- Proofread and edited
- 1-inch margins
- Double spaced
- Times or Arial font (anything easy to read)
- 12-point font (or less if you pick a larger font style)

There have been many changes in not only our national security priorities, but also in the actual structure of government bodies that are part of the national security apparatus. The objective for this assignment is to explore some of those changes and analyze the consequences, if any, these changes could mean for protecting our national security. For this assignment we are going to focus just on the treats we've covered so far, which are state actors, non-state actors, economic, identity, and environmental. Select one threat area of interest (non-state, state, economic, etc.) to investigate. Here are a few recent changes to get you started, but there are many more:

- Changing the Department of Defense (DoD) to the Department of War (DoW) and the priorities associated with the name change
- Doge cuts to DoD/DoW including cyber,
- Doge cuts to National Intelligence Agency (NIA)
- Doge cuts to CIA and other spy agencies (if such things actually exist)
- Massive Doge cuts to the Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)
- Other Doge cuts or administration reprioritizations of departments and agencies
- Reprioritization of objectives to remove environmental issues from...everything?
- Massive Doge cuts to the Department of Justice, which oversees the FBI and other counterterrorism efforts.
- Reprioritization of DoJ objectives to reduce efforts in combating extremist domestic terrorism.
- Downgrading prioritizations of tracking Russian cyber threats
- And many more...

After compiling **at least 5 sources**, which must meet the **standards for reliable resources** (see presentation in Canvas), you are expected to write a 2-page paper summarizing what you found and what conclusions you've drawn.

Below is a basic template to help you layout your paper. You are not required to use it, but it might be helpful:

Title:

Introduction: Briefly introduce your threat area of interest

Body 1: Thoroughly examine the national security threat (non-state, state, economic, etc.) you selected. You **must** use resources from the course modules (textbook, articles, videos, etc.) to support your claims and cite them accordingly.

Body 2: Discuss the changes that have been made to the national security apparatus/government structure that affect the threat you selected.

Body 3: Analyze the potential consequences and/or benefits those changes could have on the threat you selected.

Body 4: Discuss if the *ends justify the means* by briefly examining whether the cost cutting efforts have resulted in a more secure nation.

Conclusion: Conclude your paper by restating the points from introduction and wrap it all up.